



Graphics in Software Documentation

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Agenda

- ▶ Why do we need graphics? When to use a graphic?
- ▶ Types of graphics in technical writing
- ▶ Using MS Power Point to create graphics
- ▶ Using Google slides to create graphics
- ▶ Using draw.io to sketch process graphics and business processes
- ▶ Using easel.ly to create an infographic

Why?



Castelhano and Henderson's Perception of Scene Gist

As humans, we have the ability to gather context based on what we see. When we fix our eyes on something, we have the ability to form an understanding of the environment and recognize the meaning of a scene.

When?



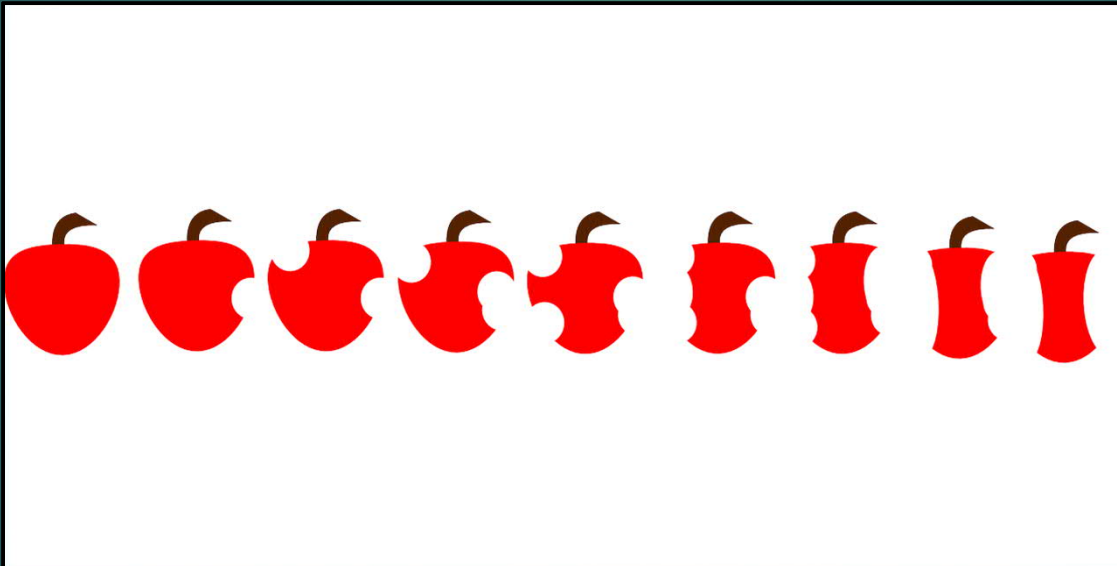
When it is possible to provide the information in visual way;
When you need to explain complex set of steps or architecture.



Types of Graphics in Software Documentation

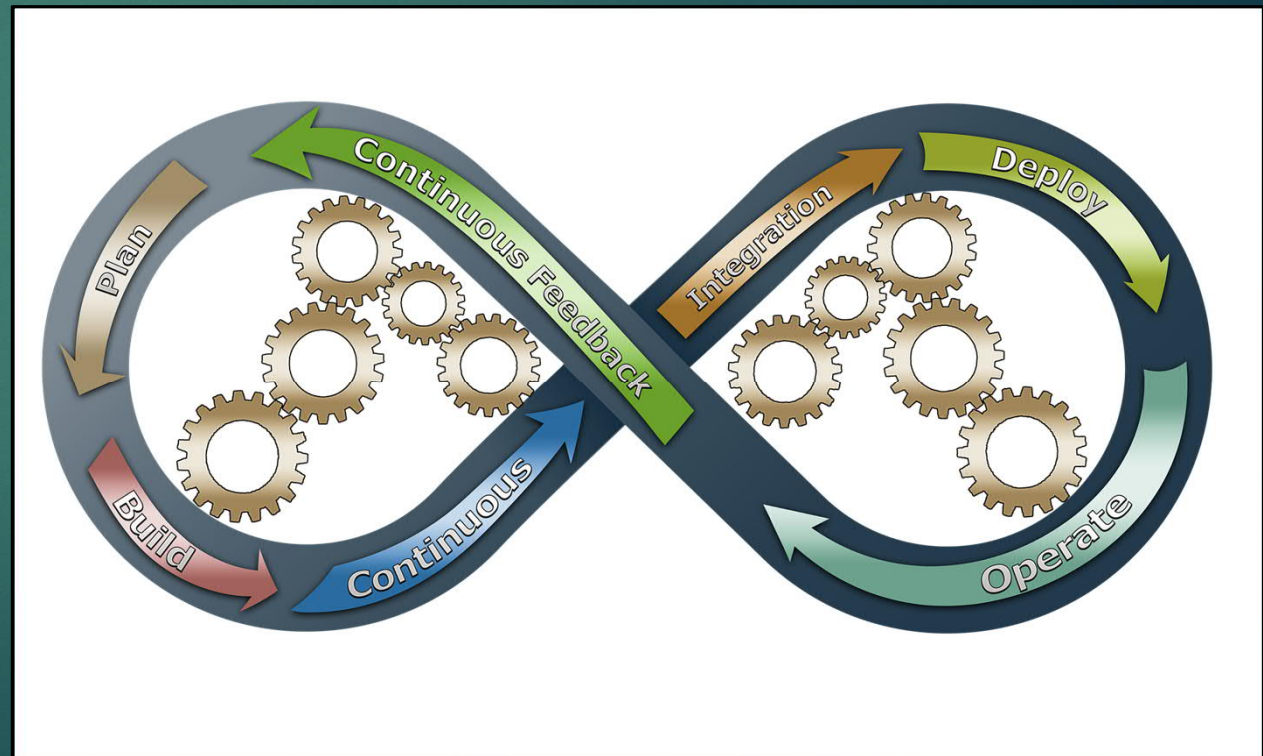
Types of graphics

► Process



Types of graphics

► Architecture



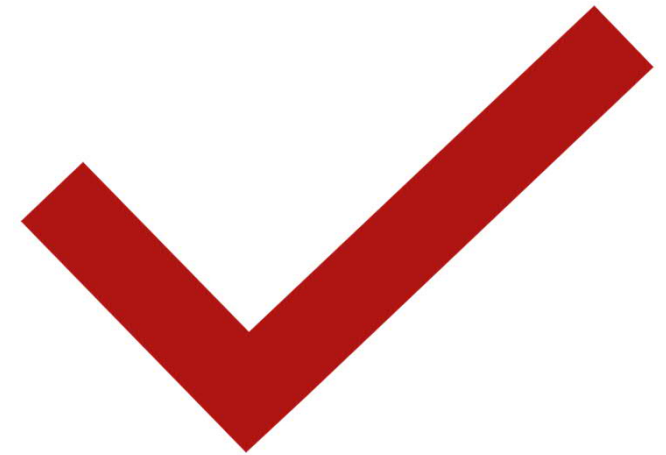
Types of graphics

Infographics



Rules for Graphics in Technical Writing

- ▶ Always explain what's in the graphic using text.
- ▶ Adhere to rules for accessibility:
 - ▶ image ALT text;
 - ▶ colors that does not confuse or affect people with color blindness, for example;
- ▶ Use consistent colors and styles across the documentation, as per your company style guide (check the S&G lecture!).
- ▶ Consider translatability options for your images (is it possible to have the text in it translated? Can you use an SVG format, for example?)



Tools for Creating Graphics

- ▶ MS Power Point
- ▶ Google Slides
- ▶ Draw.io
- ▶ Easel.ly



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Using MS Power Point to create graphics

► Demo

Using Google slides to create graphics

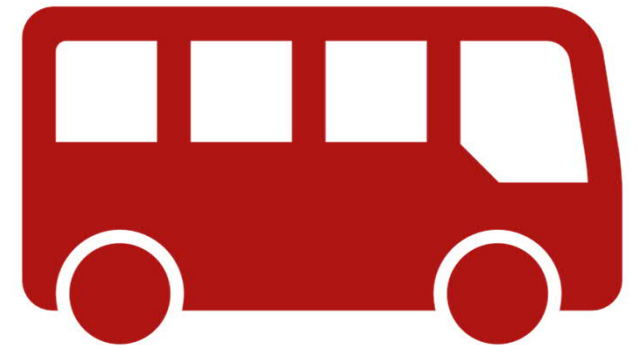
► Demo

Exercise

Using MS PowerPoint or Google Slides, create a visual representation of the following procedure:

For a tourist, visiting your city, who wants to use the city public transport, explain

How to Purchase a Bus Ticket?



Exercise Procedure Example

To pay for a bus ticket in Sofia, you have several options:

- ▶ Purchase the ticket beforehand from the kiosk for bus tickets.
- ▶ (Recommended) Purchase the ticket from the bus driver
- ▶ Purchase the ticket from a ticket machine in the bus.

Exercise Procedure Example

How to purchase the ticket from the bus driver

You need to pay 1.60 BGN for a single person ticket. If you carry a large bag, purchase additional ticket (again 1.60 BGN) for it too. Children younger than 6 years travel free of charge – no need to purchase a ticket for them.

Steps

1. Prepare the money before you get on the bus.
2. Get in the bus from the front door.
3. Ask the driver for a ticket, by saying: “Bilet, molia”.
4. Give the money to the driver.
5. Wait for the driver to give you the ticket.
6. Find and then punch the ticket using the special device in the bus.

If you do not do that, you may pay a significant fine, in case you are being checked by the authorities!

Using draw.io to sketch process graphics and business processes

► Demo

- ▶ <https://piktochart.com/blog/5-psychology-studies-that-tell-us-how-people-perceive-visual-information>
- ▶ <https://www.easel.ly/>
- ▶ <https://www.freepik.com/free-photos-vectors/infographic>
- ▶ <https://www.canva.com/create/infographics/>



Using easel.ly create an infographic

- ▶ Visualize the principles of technical writing using an infographic:
<https://jpdocu.teachable.com/p/main-principles-in-technical-writing>



- ▶ Use <https://www.easel.ly/>
- ▶ Use your infographic in a GitHub document.
- ▶ Once ready, post a link to your wiki page in [JPDocu Learning Facebook Group](#).



Summary

- ▶ Use images and graphics to increase the customer understanding of the information in your documentation.
- ▶ Remember to describe the graphic in the documentation.
- ▶ Creating graphics for documentation does not need to be complicated. So, keep it simple!





Create an Interactive Graphic in DITA

LEARN HOW TO CREATE IMAGE MAPS FOR GRAPHICS USED IN DITA
TOPICS

Steps of the Procedure

1. Create your graphic.
2. Export the graphic as a PNG file.
3. Use it in a DITA topic.
4. Using the image maps editor, configure links to underlying topics.
5. Generate the deliverable in HTML output to benefit from the interactive graphic.

Step 1: Create a Graphic Using easel.ly

1. Go to easel.ly.
2. Log on and create an infographic of choice.

Use the infographic to describe a system landscape, a set of concepts, steps in a procedure, and so on.



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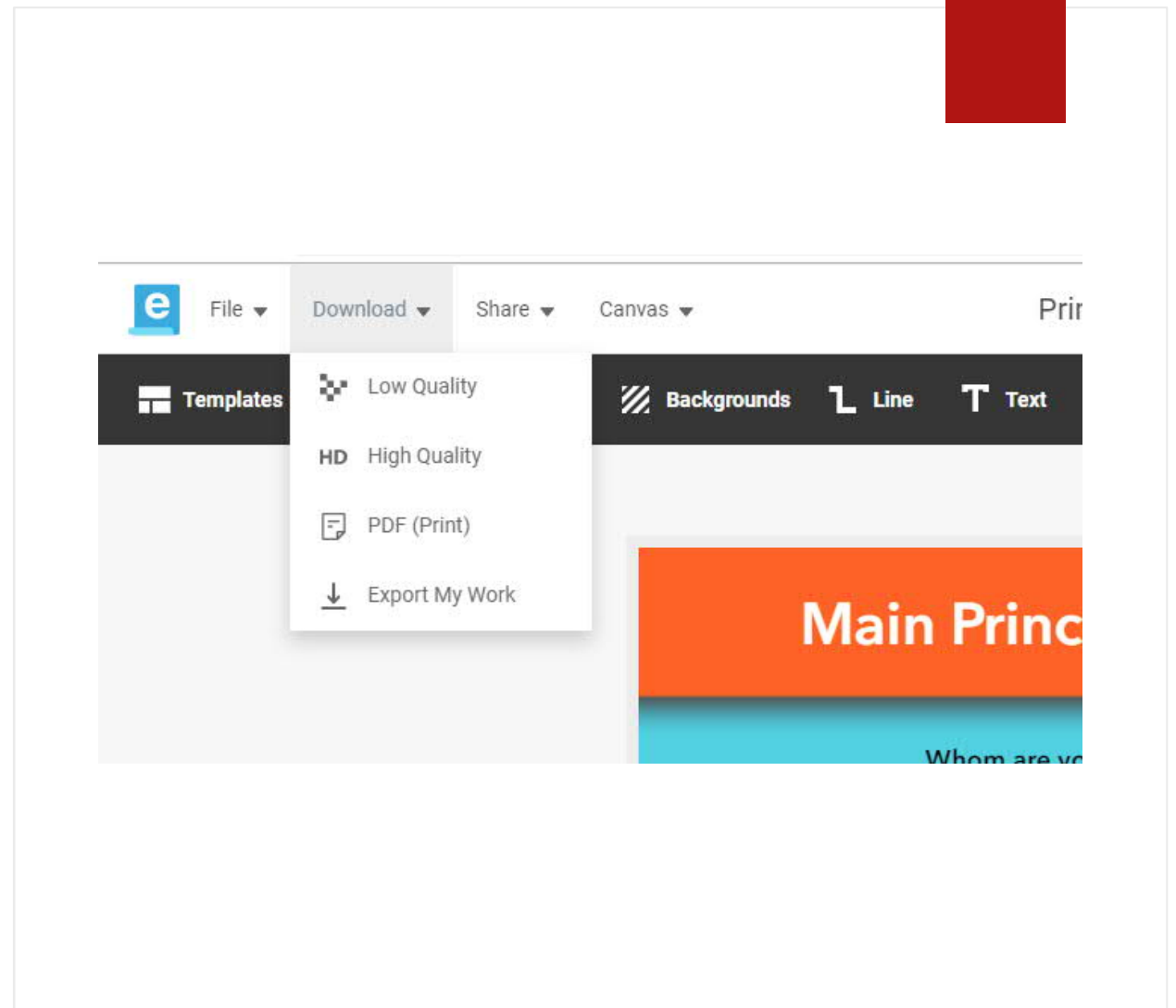
The screenshot shows the easel.ly website interface. At the top, there's a navigation bar with the easel.ly logo, links for Pricing, About, Getting Started, and Contact Us, and buttons for 'Create Your Free Account' and 'Login'. Below the navigation bar, a headline reads: 'The free way to turn wq into an engaging infographic'. The main content area is divided into two sections: 'Before easel.ly' and 'After easel.ly'. The 'Before easel.ly' section shows a table with columns for Deliverable, Description, Stage, and Definition. The 'After easel.ly' section shows three colorful, engaging infographics: 'STARTUP BUSINESS INFOGRAPHIC', 'VISIT SCOTLAND INFOGRAPHIC', and 'Have the Best Thanksgiving Ever!'. Below these sections, a text box states: 'Easel.ly is a simple infographic maker that lets you visualize any kind of information.'

Step 2: Export the Graphic

- From the menu path, choose Download > Low Quality.

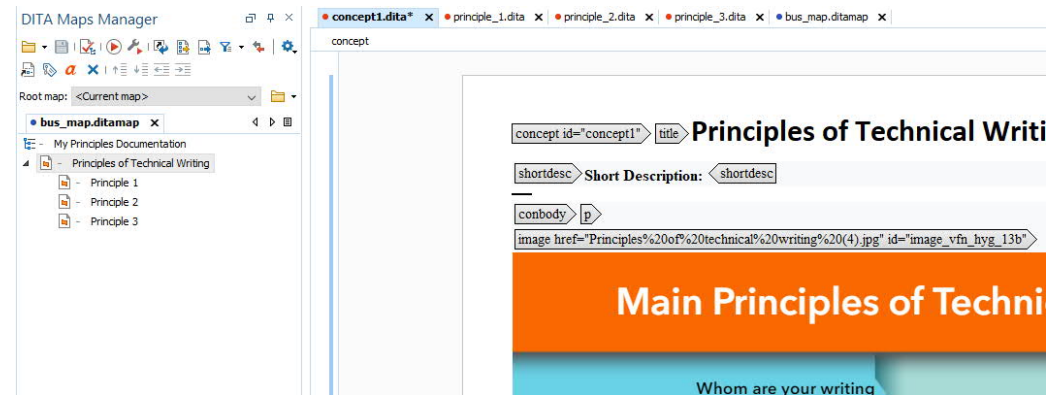


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Step 3: Use it in a DITA topic

1. Create a DITA map and the DITA topics to navigate across.
2. In the introductory DITA topic, drag-and-drop the image file, for example in a `<p>` tag.



Step 4: Use the image maps editor

1. Open the context menu over the imported image.
2. Choose Image Map Editor...

